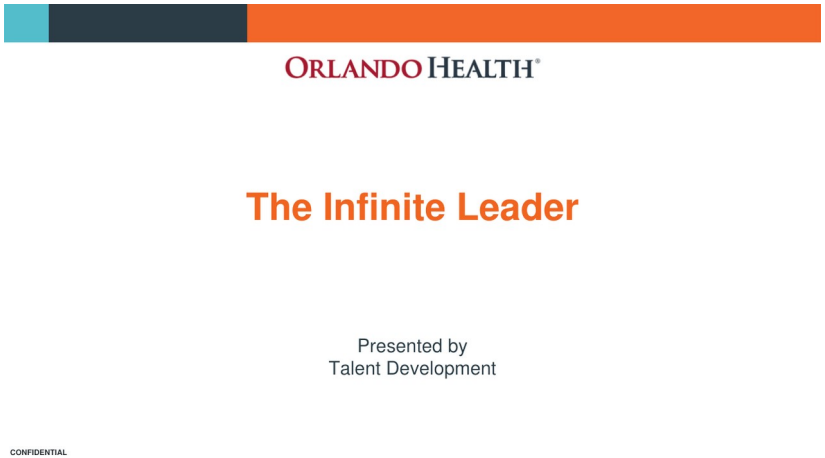
The Infinite Leader

Facilitator Guide | Slide 1 of 9

The Infinite Leader



TIMING: 1:00 | 0:00–1:00

SESSION: Target 13 minutes, including brief discussion. For 12 minutes, take one response per prompt. For 15 minutes, allow one additional example.

SAY:

Welcome to today's Nurse Leader Huddle. If your day has been full of urgent requests, it can be hard to make room for anything beyond the next problem. Today we will look at how to meet today's needs while building capability and continuity for the future.

ASK:

What is one problem your team still depends on you to solve when you are not there?

FACILITATE:

Allow 15 seconds of reflection. Invite one short example without naming a team member.

SAY:

Keep that example in mind. We will distinguish three leadership horizons and identify one manageable action you can take this week.

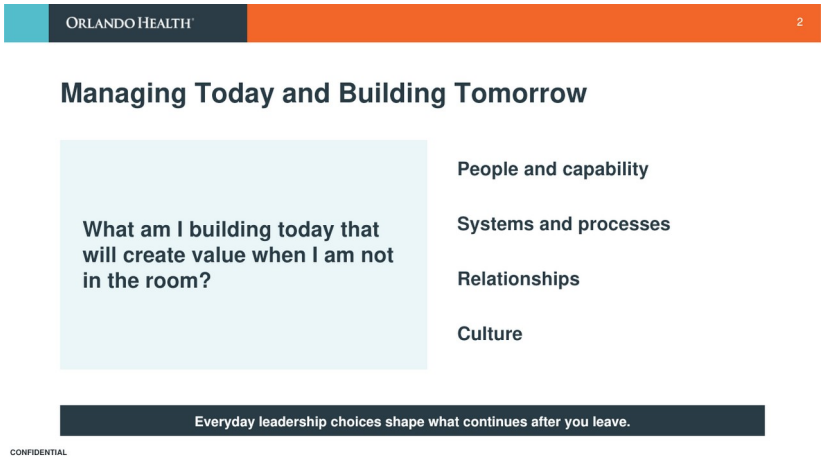
TRANSITION:

Let's consider what your everyday leadership choices are building.

The Infinite Leader

Facilitator Guide | Slide 2 of 9

Managing Today and Building Tomorrow



TIMING: 1:20 | 1:00–2:20

SAY:

Most leaders are naturally pulled toward urgent priorities. The staffing gap. The escalation. The message that needs an answer in the next ten minutes. Those priorities matter, and I am not going to stand here and tell you to ignore them.

At the same time, leadership includes preparing others and strengthening the environment for future success. And that work almost never announces itself. Capability building can be easy to postpone when the benefit is less immediate.

So a useful question is this: "What am I building today that will continue to create value when I am not in the room?"

Think about the shifts you are not there for. The nights, the weekends, the vacation you have been meaning to take. What happens then is the real measure of what you have built.

The four areas on the slide are people and capability, systems and processes, relationships, and culture. They describe what daily leadership choices can strengthen over time.

TRANSITION:

Let's think about what leaders leave behind.

The Infinite Leader

Facilitator Guide | Slide 3 of 9

What Leaders Leave Behind



TIMING: 1:15 | 2:20–3:35

SAY:

The most meaningful leadership contributions often continue long after a specific project or initiative ends.

Leaders can leave greater team capability and independence, more reliable systems and processes, shared knowledge, and stronger working relationships.

Here is a test for this. Think about a leader who influenced you early in your career. Consider something they taught you, a standard they held, or a way of thinking you still use today. That is what lasted.

The goal is not simply solving today's problem. The goal is helping future teams face fewer problems and solve challenges more effectively.

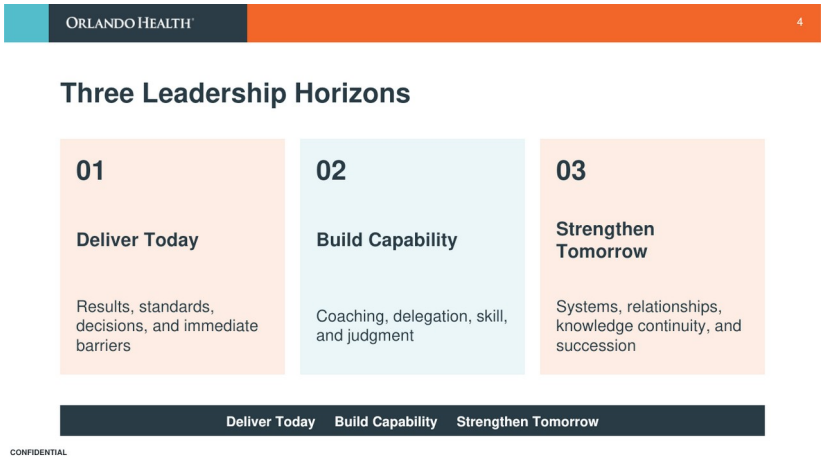
TRANSITION:

One way to think about this is through three leadership horizons.

The Infinite Leader

Facilitator Guide | Slide 4 of 9

Three Leadership Horizons



TIMING: 1:25 | 3:35–5:00

SAY:

The three leadership horizons are Deliver Today, Build Capability, and Strengthen Tomorrow. All three matter, and they can overlap in daily work.

Deliver Today focuses on current results, standards, decisions, and immediate barriers.

Build Capability focuses on people: coaching, supported delegation, skill, and judgment. Developing future leaders belongs here because it develops individuals.

Strengthen Tomorrow focuses on what helps the team continue to work effectively over time: systems, relationships, knowledge continuity, and succession plans. A continuity plan identifies how important work will continue when someone is absent or changes roles.

FACILITATOR TIP:

Ask what the action primarily changes. Developing a person's ability is Build Capability. Improving a process or continuity plan is Strengthen Tomorrow.

REFLECT:

Which horizon has received the least of your attention recently? Pause for 10 seconds.

TRANSITION:

Let's compare today's delivery with building capability in others.

The Infinite Leader

Facilitator Guide | Slide 5 of 9

Deliver Today and Build Capability



TIMING: 1:25 | 5:00–6:25

SAY:

The first horizon focuses on today's work. Leaders must address current priorities, remove barriers, create clarity, and maintain standards. This is real leadership work. None of it is beneath you and none of it is optional.

The second horizon focuses on building capability. Coaching instead of rescuing. Delegating with support rather than delegating and disappearing. Developing judgment in other people. Sharing what you know and developing future leaders through supported experience.

Here is the honest tension. Sometimes the fastest solution is doing the work ourselves. Doing it yourself may feel faster than coaching someone through it. In the moment, that time pressure is real.

Repeatedly taking over can keep the team dependent on you. The leadership opportunity is recognizing when coaching, delegating, or teaching creates greater long-term value. Developing others may take longer today but often creates stronger performance tomorrow.

TRANSITION:

The third horizon focuses on what we are building for the future.

The Infinite Leader

Facilitator Guide | Slide 6 of 9

Strengthen Tomorrow



TIMING: 1:25 | 6:25–7:50

SAY:

Strengthen Tomorrow focuses on systems and continuity. Ask yourself: What would make this team more successful six months from now?

Improve recurring systems and processes. Think of a handoff that causes repeated confusion or a workaround the team has quietly accepted.

Build working relationships before a difficult issue requires urgent cooperation.

Create continuity and succession plans. Identify essential work, who can cover it, and what information or preparation they need. The plan belongs in this horizon. Coaching the person to build the needed skills belongs in Build Capability.

Document institutional knowledge so important instructions and decisions do not depend on one person's memory.

FACILITATOR TIP:

“Leave the work better than you found it” can be a useful reminder. Choose one change that continues to help after the immediate issue is resolved.

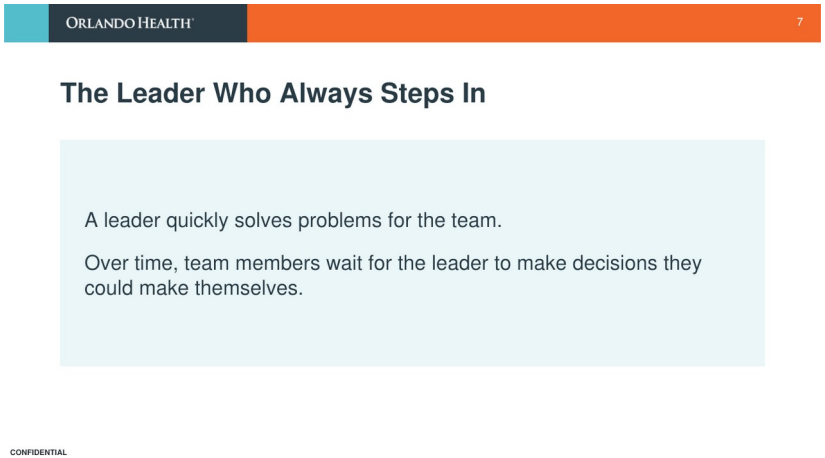
TRANSITION:

Let's consider what happens when a team depends on one leader to solve every problem.

The Infinite Leader

Facilitator Guide | Slide 7 of 9

The Leader Who Always Steps In



TIMING: 2:15 | 7:50–10:05

SAY:

Imagine a responsive leader who quickly steps in when problems arise. The team appreciates the support. Over time, team members increasingly wait for this leader before making decisions they could make within their roles.

ASK:

What could the leader do next time to support the team and build greater independence?

FACILITATE:

Allow 20 seconds of thought and take two short responses. Avoid suggesting that leaders should always step back. Urgency, risk, the team member's readiness, and scope of responsibility all matter.

DEBRIEF:

Deliver Today: address immediate needs and protect standards.

Build Capability: ask the team member for a proposed approach, clarify decision boundaries, and offer a check-in rather than automatically taking over.

Strengthen Tomorrow: document recurring decision guidance and a coverage plan so the work can continue when the leader is absent.

FACILITATOR TIP:

A workable first step might be: “What do you recommend, and where would you like support?” Use this only when the situation allows time for learning.

TRANSITION:

Small, intentional choices can develop people and improve how the team works.

The Infinite Leader

Facilitator Guide | Slide 8 of 9

Future-Building Opportunities



TIMING: 1:25 | 10:05–11:30

SAY:

Future-focused leadership often shows up in simple decisions.

You might develop someone by turning a task into a learning opportunity. Turn a routine task into a supported learning opportunity. Agree on the expected outcome, boundaries, and when to check in.

You might improve a process that creates recurring frustration. Not a formal initiative. just the one workaround your team has quietly accepted for months.

Or you might invest in a relationship that will strengthen future collaboration. The partner in pharmacy, or imaging, or environmental services you only call when something has already gone wrong.

Choose a small action within your role and authority. Some process or partnership changes will need agreement from others. Small actions can build toward longer-term improvement.

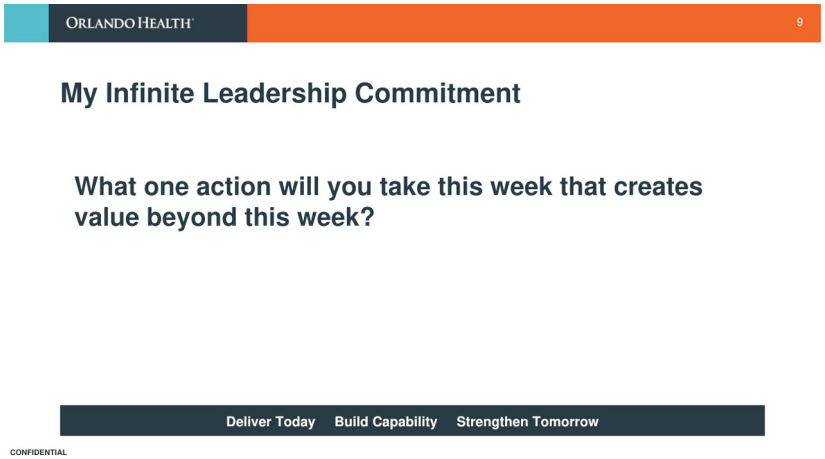
TRANSITION:

Let's finish by identifying one future-building action.

The Infinite Leader

Facilitator Guide | Slide 9 of 9

My Infinite Leadership Commitment



TIMING: 1:30 | 11:30–13:00

SAY:

Choose one action you will take this week that creates value beyond this week's immediate priorities. You might turn a routine task into supported learning, address a recurring workaround, or invest in a working relationship. Make the action specific enough to begin this week.

CHAT ENGAGEMENT:

Ask: “What one action will you take this week, and when will you start?” Allow 15 seconds of reflection and 30 seconds for chat responses. In person, invite two brief responses. Acknowledge the action and the horizon it supports.

CLOSE:

Deliver Today. Build Capability. Strengthen Tomorrow. Keep meeting current needs while making deliberate room for capability and continuity. Thank you for being here.